more than a specified number. The rest of the major roads should remain intrastate and state highways connecting at major points to national highways.

No such load study has been carried out and presented to the public about the national highways' length of over 1.3 lakh km and the candidate ('in-principle') national highways of over 60,000 km. If one were to take into account a number of low-volume highways declared as national highways, there does not appear to be a good justification for the claim of such a large network of national highways.

Share of Industry in Power has Been Constantly Declining

The share of industry in electricity consumption in India was quite high at 71 per cent in 1947. As India industrialized during the First and Second Plan periods (1951–61), industry's share in total power consumption went up further, peaking at 75 per cent at the end of 1960–61, when the Second Five-Year Plan ended. The share of industry in power consumption was still high at 72 per cent at the beginning of the 1970s.

Expansion of electricity supply to agriculture and later, from the early 1980s, to residential consumers, led the relative share of industry to fall steadily in the 1970s and 1980s. By the end of the 1970s, industry's share in electricity consumption had fallen to 62 per cent, and to a little over 51 per cent in 1989–90. Industry's share of electricity consumption fell by more than 20 per cent in twenty years. This trend continued unabated with industry consuming only 46 per cent at the end of the Tenth Plan in 2006–07.

The share of industry as a consumer of electricity in India was only marginally above 40 per cent in 2018–19. The share would fall below 40 per cent any time soon.

Not only does industry have a paltry share in total electricity use, it is voting with its feet in buying electricity from distribution companies